



BEFORE

Despite their victory, the Confederates were in disarray after [Chickamauga](#). Meanwhile, the Union leadership rallied to redeem what it could from defeat.

SITUATION AT CHATTANOOGA

Bragg's lethargy after **Chickamauga** caused his principal generals to turn against him, claiming he was **unfit for command**. But Longstreet did not wish to take command of the army himself, so Bragg was retained, **leaving morale low**.

Bragg's forces **controlled the high ground to the east of Chattanooga** and prevented supplies from reaching the town except by one circuitous route. This did not allow enough food to reach the besieged Union army. Lincoln knew something must be done. The man he chose to resolve the crisis was **Ulysses S. Grant**, fresh from **his triumph at Vicksburg**.

In mid-October, Lincoln reorganized the Union's Western geographic command structure. The new Division of the Mississippi, which included all of the territory between the Appalachians and the river, fell under the command of Ulysses S. Grant. With his new authority, Grant headed for Chattanooga, where he relieved Rosecrans and installed George Thomas as commander of the Army of the Cumberland.

One Federal officer wrote about Grant's arrival, "We began to see things move. We felt that everything came from a plan." By the end of October the crisis in the city had ended. New supply lines were in place, and 17,000 fresh troops had arrived under Sherman. Union morale was restored. Conversely, their Confederate foes, though still occupying the high ground that dominated the Federal positions, were again outnumbered and racked with command and morale problems.